CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

DISPATCHER (TRUCKING) IN THE AI ERA

Software can plan a route. It still can't calm down a driver stuck at a dock at 2 a.m.

★ TL;DR — Median ~$45K, fully remote-capable, learnable in 1–6 months with no license. The catch: dispatch software is strong here, so the job is shrinking toward exception-handling and relationships. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

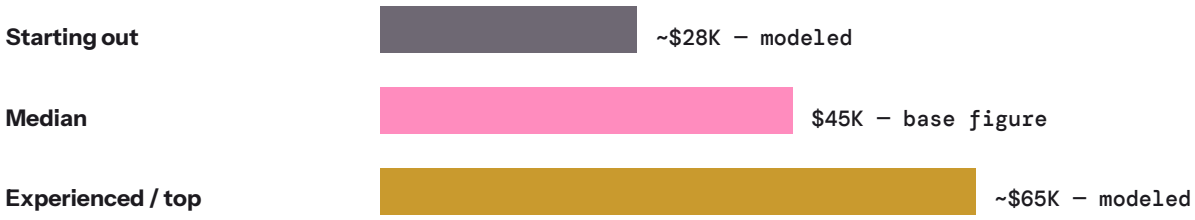
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$45K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK MEDIUM

- No license, no degree — dispatch is one of trucking's fastest office entries.
- Fully remote: independent dispatchers run other people's trucks from a laptop anywhere.
- AI books, routes and tracks standard loads well; humans keep the chaos when it breaks.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Dispatcher (trucking) is a ~$45K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A DISPATCHER (TRUCKING) ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Match trucks to loads and negotiate rates with brokers

- ✓ Plan routes and schedules around hours-of-service rules
- ✓ Track drivers and solve delays, breakdowns and detention
- ✓ Handle paperwork: rate confirmations, bills of lading, invoicing

Think: an air-traffic controller for trucks, with a phone that never stops.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Load boards, route optimization and automated check-calls do the routine matching and tracking. AI agents increasingly book standard loads end to end.	The breakdown, the angry broker, the driver who wants to quit mid-route — exceptions and relationships are the surviving core of the job.

⚠ **Beginner pay is a race to the bottom, and the routine half of the job is exactly what software eats first.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Work from anywhere with a laptop and a headset ✓ Fast entry, skill-based, no credential gate ✓ Independent dispatchers choose their own client list	✗ On-call energy: freight problems don't keep office hours ✗ Screen-and-phone work, all day, every day ✗ Income pressure if you go independent before you have carriers

Good fit? Organized, fast on the phone, and calm when three problems land at once.
Bad fit? You hate phones, multitasking, or being the person everyone calls when it breaks.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — HIRE ON AT A CARRIER OR 3PL	DOOR B — INDEPENDENT DISPATCH SERVICE
Trucking companies and logistics firms hire trainee dispatchers and teach their systems. Steady paycheck, real volume, and the fastest way to learn freight without risking your own money.	Sell per-truck dispatch support to small carriers and owner-operators. You find your own clients, charge a percentage or flat fee, and run everything remotely — flexible, but client hunting is on you.

Smart move: Learn one freight niche (reefer, flatbed, one region) deeply — niche dispatchers are much harder to replace with software.
Where you land after: Senior dispatcher → operations manager, or an independent service with a stable of carriers.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
LEARN HOW	TAKE A	PRACTICE THE	GET HIRED	RUN YOUR	SCALE OR

STEP 1 — Learn how freight moves

FREE · TODAY

- Understand load boards, rate confirmations, bills of lading and hours-of-service basics from free industry material.
- Pick a niche: dry van, reefer or flatbed.

STEP 2 — Take a short dispatch course

LOW COST · 1-6 MONTHS

- A focused course teaches the workflow, the software and broker calls in weeks.
- No license is required — competence is the credential.

STEP 3 — Practice the tools

FREE · WEEKS

- Get fluent in load boards, maps/spreadsheets and TMS demos where available.
- Speed and accuracy with paperwork is what carriers pay for.

STEP 4 — Get hired or signed

MONTHS 1-3

- Apply to carriers and 3PLs for trainee seats, or pitch small carriers a trial week.
- Owner-operators with a few trucks are the classic first independent clients.

STEP 5 — Run your board

DAILY

- Book, track and communicate before problems happen.
- Document everything — disputes are won with paperwork.

STEP 6 — Scale or specialize

MONTH 3+

- Add trucks or raise rates as your reliability becomes known.
- Exception-heavy freight (oversize, expedited) pays for human judgment.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- Today: learn the basic vocabulary and pick a freight niche.
- Days 1–30: course underway; practice on load boards daily.
- Days 31–60: apply for trainee roles and pitch small carriers a trial.
- Days 61–90: running live loads with supervision, or your first client trucks.

 Day 90: a working dispatcher — board running, employer or clients secured.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **SOFTWARE ROUTES. HUMANS RESCUE.** ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.